

What Reddit says about friends, predictions & keeping score.

We read 35 real conversations where people describe making calls, bets and challenges with friends — how they set them up, settle them, and why it falls apart. Every quote in this report is copied word for word and links to the original comment.

35

threads read

1,085

comments

94

verified quotes

5

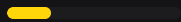
subreddits

Where the evidence comes from

All data comes from public Reddit threads. A person opened each page in their own browser and saved it; the analysis ran on those saved copies. Nothing was paraphrased into a quote.

21

Searches run



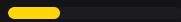
757

Posts found



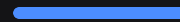
35

Threads read



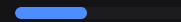
1,085

Comments read



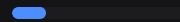
94

Quotes kept



10

Findings



By community

SUBREDDIT	THREADS	COMMENTS READ
r/SideProject	14	166
r/FFCommish	10	418
r/getdisciplined	5	265
r/Discord_Bots	3	17
r/fantasyfootball	3	219

Why these communities? r/FFCommish is where fantasy-league commissioners — the people who run season-long friend competitions — discuss rules, punishments and disputes. r/SideProject shows the tools people build for this and how their users react. r/getdisciplined covers friend challenges and accountability. r/Discord_Bots shows groups asking for prediction and points bots.

Not every search finds the right people

Reddit search ranks by upvotes, not relevance. Three real searches from this project, rendered from the saved results — the first two show Reddit's top 4 by upvotes. **READ** marks threads we actually pulled and quoted; when a search returned noise we changed communities.



bet with your friend

in r/AskReddit

Top · All time

50 results · 0 threads read from this search · [re-run this search](#)

- ▲ 1,808 Reddit, I'm broke and need a new wheelchair. If I sold ad space on my current wheelchair an...
757 comments · Sep 2010 **SKIPPED**
- ▲ 1,151 How can I track these good people down to thank them?
433 comments · Sep 2010 **SKIPPED**
- ▲ 1,134 Why aren't gyms also generators of electricity? Surely all the cycling and rowing machines c...
779 comments · Mar 2012 **SKIPPED**
- ▲ 140 One of my Best Friends needs a liver. I need your help, reddit :(.
89 comments · Sep 2010 **SKIPPED**

Our first pilot. The word "bet" matches everything — wheelchairs, dating, nightmares, mostly 2009–2013.

Dropped.



last place punishment

in r/fantasyfootball

Top · Past year

50 results · 1 thread read from this search · [re-run this search](#)

- ▲ 2,972 NFL is placing Packers RB Josh Jacobs on the commissioner exempt list. Last week Jacobs was ...
1132 comments · Aug 2026 **SKIPPED**
- ▲ 1,211 We analyzed thousands of redraft leagues. Last year's champs are drafting DeVonta, Tuten, an...
341 comments · Sep 2026 **SKIPPED**
- ▲ 1,112 My 2026 Top-144 Full Player Ranking & Tier List [With Draft Guide + Google Sheets]
390 comments · Aug 2026 **SKIPPED**
- ▲ 972 Fantasy football has a trading problem and I'm here to fix it.
456 comments · Oct 2025 **SKIPPED**

r/fantasyfootball bans league-specific posts, so its top results are player analysis. **Switched to r/FFCommish.**



punishment in r/FFCommish

Top · Past year

50 results · 6 threads read from this search · [re-run this search](#)

- ▲ 25 What does your fantasy league/commissioner do that actually makes your league feel unique?
84 comments · Sep 2026 **READ**
- ▲ 5 What is your league's last place punishment?
49 comments · Dec 2025 **READ**
- ▲ 2 How to deal with player not doing punishment
49 comments · Sep 2026 **READ**
- ▲ 0 Forfeit Enforcement Debate From Last Season
37 comments · Aug 2026 **READ**

The commissioners' community: punishments, enforcement and disputes — exactly the behaviour we were looking for. Shown: the threads we read from this search, by comments. **Kept.**

Agree on the rules before anyone knows who wins

The fight almost always starts after someone loses. Consequences need everyone's yes — not a majority.

9 of 35 threads

SOURCE THREAD

Forfeit Enforcement Debate From Last Season

r/FFCommish ▲ 1 37 comments (36 read) Aug 2026

"specific punishment should be agreed on before the season"

r/FFCommish ▲ 7 Aug 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"everyone needs to agree to it before the season. It's one of the few things where a simple majority isn't enough."

r/FFCommish ▲ 2 Aug 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"the people coming here realize they never actually thought about this in advance and want us to solve the problem for them after the fact"

r/fantasyfootball ▲ 25 Dec 2025 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

FOR THE GAME

Terms already lock when the first friend joins. Next: stakes and punishments must be agreed by everyone before lock.

Agreements go unenforced

Losers dodge punishments for months, and friend groups rarely kick a friend out to enforce them.

4 of 35 threads

SOURCE THREAD

How to deal with player not doing punishment

r/FFCommish ▲ 3 49 comments (44 read) Sep 2026

"He has had 8 months to do so and has not managed to perform the punishment."

r/FFCommish ▲ 3 Sep 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"getting him to do it has been like pulling teeth"

r/FFCommish ▲ 0 Sep 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"Guy who came in last totally disappeared and never did it."

r/FFCommish ▲ 1 Dec 2025 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

FOR THE GAME

Add a visible Still owes status on the challenge and rivalry page until the winner confirms it's done.

One person does all the work

The organizer tracks scores, chases people and builds the records — and it collapses when their life gets busy.

9 of 35 threads

SOURCE THREAD

What does your fantasy league/commissioner do that actually makes your league feel unique?

r/FFCommish ▲ 25 84 comments (84 read) Sep 2026

"The only issue is we then have to collate the results manually and put them in a spreadsheet afterwards"

r/Discord_Bots ▲ 1 Feb 2021 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"Life got busy once our son was born though and I started missing weeks and it broke down."

r/FFCommish ▲ 1 Oct 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"I think maybe one guy gave a shit."

r/FFCommish ▲ 15 Sep 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

FOR THE GAME

Scoring and locking are automatic. Next: reminders sent by the app, so nobody has to chase friends.

That person's power makes people nervous

Unchecked organizers change rules alone, collude, or sit on the money.

4 of 35 threads

SOURCE THREAD

Commissioner overrides vetoes and cancels trades — am I overreacting?

r/FFCommish ▲ 7 30 comments (27 read) Oct 2025

"Some in our group (including me) thought this was collusion, but since Mike was the commissioner, nothing was done about it."

r/FFCommish ▲ 7 Oct 2025 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"Your commish spent the money"

r/FFCommish ▲ 56 Jan 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"a good commissioner is a facilitator"

r/FFCommish ▲ 1 Jan 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

FOR THE GAME

Built: no silent edits, full history, group-confirmed results — make that visible as a selling point.

FINDING 5 OF 5 · SEEN IN 7 SEPARATE THREADS

The fun dies mid-season

Whoever falls out of contention stops caring, and the group chat goes quiet.

7 of 35 threads

SOURCE THREAD

Commishes – how do you keep your league alive after Week 8?

r/FFCommish ▲ 3 33 comments (32 read) Aug 2025

"groupchat starts to feel dead"

r/FFCommish ▲ 3 Aug 2025 App builder

[Open comment ↗](#)

"Pool death is real problem"

r/SideProject ▲ 1 May 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

"Weekly prizes in my experience tend to just favor the already strong teams who are going to win money anyway."

r/FFCommish ▲ 2 Feb 2025 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

FOR THE GAME

Give players out of contention something to play for: side calls and head-to-head rivalries that stay live.

Weaker, but real

Each appears in at least 4 separate threads. One representative quote per pattern.

The friend group is the motivation

7 threads

"When you make fun of someone for sucking and not setting their lineup to everyone in the pool, they pay attention."

r/FFCommish ▲ 11 Aug 2025 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

Money vs punishment vs bragging rights — genuine disagreement

8 threads

"HR rules means no money involved"

r/SideProject ▲ 1 Jun 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

It lives in the group chat (WhatsApp, Discord, iMessage)

6 threads

"would be good as an iMessage addon like game pigeon"

r/SideProject ▲ 1 Jul 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

People keep looking — and 12+ small tools already exist

8 threads

"I am looking for a free pool i can setup and run with my friends."

r/SideProject ▲ 1 May 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

People want picks locked so nobody can change them

4 threads

"Is there a way for the admin to lock choosing the winner so that it cannot be changed?"

r/SideProject ▲ 1 Jun 2026 Reddit user

[Open comment ↗](#)

From quotes to features

WHAT REDDIT SAYS	WHAT THE GAME SHOULD DO	STATUS
Agree before anyone knows who wins	Terms lock when the first friend joins; changes need everyone	Built
Consequences need everyone's yes	Stakes / punishments chosen up front, unanimously	Gap
Losers dodge the punishment	Visible Still owes status until the winner confirms it's done	Gap
One person does all the work	Auto-scoring, auto-lock, app-sent reminders	Partial
Organizer power makes people nervous	No silent edits, audit history, group-confirmed results	Built
Fun dies mid-season	Side challenges and rivalries for players out of contention	Gap
It lives in the group chat	One-tap join from a link; later a chat add-on	Partial
Money vs punishment vs bragging	Points only; each group chooses its own extras	Partial

BUILD NEXT

1. **Unanimous stakes** — the group agrees what the loser does before the challenge locks.
2. **Follow-through tracking** — a visible **Still owes** badge until the winner confirms.
3. **A reason to keep playing when you're losing** — side calls and head-to-head rivalries that stay live all season.

Good for **what to build**. Weak for **will they use it**.

A

Do the quotes say what we claim?

All 94 quotes checked word for word against the saved comments; every link points to the original

B

Is it about our exact problem?

Strong on season-long groups and organizers; thin on quick one-off calls between friends

C+

Is it the right kind of people?

13 of 35 threads are fantasy football — mostly men, often with money. Families and coworkers appear secondhand

B+

Is it recent?

Mostly 2025–2026 (range Nov 2020 – Oct 2026); a handful cluster around the 2026 World Cup

D

Does it show people will switch to our app?

It shows pain and wishes, not behaviour. Nobody here tried the game.

Also: 76% of quotes are from users, the rest from people who built apps (who are motivated to say the problem is real). Upvote counts on many key comments are small — this is a community's conversation, not a survey.

Reddit shows what hurts. Only behaviour shows what people do.

Saying isn't doing

"I am looking for a free pool" costs nothing to type.
Using an app costs time and friends' attention.

Self-selected sample

People who post already looked for a tool. Groups happy with WhatsApp don't post — so we can't size the problem.

Evidence cuts both ways

12+ tools exist and people still ask. Unmet demand — or tools that don't stick? Reddit can't tell.

The chat is "good enough"

The real competitor is free and already open.
Interviewee Liam: "Another app might be more effort than the problem deserves."

Nothing measures coming back

Engagement dies in weeks 2–8. Posts don't track that.

How we find out — cheapest first

1

Past behaviour

Ask: when did you last track a bet with friends?
Show me.

Pass: 3 of 6 show something real

2

Landing page

Page + a Start-a-challenge button

Pass: 10%+ sign up and invite a friend

3

Concierge

Run challenges by hand in 3 groups' chats for 2 weeks

Pass: A group asks for a 2nd challenge unprompted

4

Pilot

3–5 groups use the real app for 2–4 weeks

Pass: Hits the thresholds below

PILOT PASS MARKS — SET BEFORE STARTING

70%

invited friends join in 48h

60%

members pick each challenge

2+ /wk

new challenges per group in week 3

80%

results confirmed by the group

The one number that matters most: a **second challenge created without being asked**. The first is curiosity; the second is a habit forming.

Sources

COMMUNITY	THREAD (CLICK TO OPEN)	DATE	COMMENTS
r/Discord_Bots	"Called it"/"Quote me on this"/"I bet that..." Bot	Nov 2020	3
r/Discord_Bots	Result Prediction and Counter Bot	Feb 2021	5
r/Discord_Bots	Looking for a bot similar to Twitch's chat points/predictions features	Aug 2021	11
r/FFCommish	Weekly Side Bets and Prizes Not Worth it?	Feb 2025	9
r/FFCommish	Commishes – how do you keep your league alive after Week 8?	Aug 2025	33
r/FFCommish	When should a fantasy football commissioner use his powers?	Oct 2025	80
r/FFCommish	Commissioner overrides vetoes and cancels trades — am I overreacting?	Oct 2025	30
r/FFCommish	What is your league's last place punishment?	Dec 2025	49
r/FFCommish	Suggested modernized rule changes and now the Head Commish wants to qu...	Jan 2026	36
r/FFCommish	Forfeit Enforcement Debate From Last Season	Aug 2026	37
r/FFCommish	Our league uses a half beer mile to determine draft position. One mana...	Aug 2026	36
r/FFCommish	How to deal with player not doing punishment	Sep 2026	49
r/FFCommish	What does your fantasy league/commissioner do that actually makes your...	Sep 2026	84
r/SideProject	I have spent 2.5 years working on my side project and yesterday got th...	May 2024	51
r/SideProject	New app I made to let me and my friends make bets as a group	Nov 2025	11
r/SideProject	I just launched my side project — it locks your predictions so you can...	Feb 2026	1
r/SideProject	I built a free F1 prediction game in 54 days — session analysis, priva...	Mar 2026	2
r/SideProject	I built a free app for tracking golf bets with your friends	Apr 2026	4

Sources

COMMUNITY	THREAD (CLICK TO OPEN)	DATE	COMMENTS
r/SideProject	Built a free, ad-free World Cup 2026 predictions game for playing with...	Apr 2026	17
r/SideProject	Shipped a mobile app to settle a Gym argument with my teenage son	May 2026	2
r/SideProject	I built a free World Cup 2026 bracket predictor — shareable, no signup...	May 2026	13
r/SideProject	I built a game where you can 1v1 your friends in quick mini brain batt...	May 2026	6
r/SideProject	World Cup 2026 prediction pool website to play with friends and cowork...	May 2026	72
r/SideProject	Built a spread-prediction game for the World Cup to play with friends....	Jun 2026	6
r/SideProject	World Cup Sweepstakes Generator - picks multiple teams, live leaderboa...	Jun 2026	15
r/SideProject	I built a free, ad-free app for running football prediction leagues wi...	Jun 2026	4
r/SideProject	Would your group chat bet fake money on each other? I built a predicti...	Jul 2026	4
r/fantasyfootball	Welcome to the annual Justify My Anti-Competitive Behavior fortnight o...	Nov 2025	85
r/fantasyfootball	Friends, it's the holidays. Enough with the "can someone use waivers i...	Dec 2025	91
r/fantasyfootball	Your Fantasy League Deserves Its Own Sports Network	Jul 2026	57
r/getdisciplined	[Method] My boyfriend has a bet with our two friends that if any of th...	Oct 2021	20
r/getdisciplined	[Method] I set a \$500 penalty if I drink alcohol in the next 14 days	Jan 2026	41
r/getdisciplined	My friend group found the dumbest way to actually stick to habits and ...	Mar 2026	46
r/getdisciplined	Looking for 5–7 people to build a serious accountability group (WhatsA...	Sep 2026	151
r/getdisciplined	Starting a 90-day show-up challenge on October 12. Looking for 10–20 p...	Oct 2026	59

Every search we ran

All sorted by top. **Threads read** = threads from that search we actually pulled and analysed. Click a query to re-run it on Reddit.

COMMUNITY	QUERY	TIME RANGE	RESULTS	THREADS READ
r/AskReddit	bet with your friend	All time	50	0
r/fantasyfootball	pick em league	Past year	50	0
r/googlesheets	pick em	All time	11	0
r/Discord_Bots	prediction bot	All time	17	3
r/SideProject	bets with friends	All time	50	9
r/getdisciplined	accountability bet	All time	42	2
r/loseit	challenge with friends	All time	50	0
r/fantasyfootball	commissioner group chat	Past year	35	1
r/Discord_Bots	betting bot points	All time	50	0
r/fantasyfootball	last place punishment	Past year	50	1
r/fantasyfootball	side bet league	Past year	50	0
r/fantasyfootball	league rules dispute	Past year	50	2
r/getdisciplined	bet with my friend	Past year	12	0
r/getdisciplined	challenge friends accountability	Past year	50	3
r/loseit	weight loss bet	Past year	50	0
r/loseit	group challenge	Past year	17	0
r/SideProject	friends leaderboard	Past year	50	5
r/SideProject	group chat predictions	Past year	50	2
r/FFCommish	punishment	Past year	50	6
r/FFCommish	side bet	All time	25	4
r/FFCommish	rules dispute	Past year	5	0

Method. Framing agreed first (target user: friend groups that care about follow-through). Pages saved by a person in their own browser — Reddit blocks automated tools. Threads chosen by relevance, then by comment count. A pattern counts only if it appears in 3+ separate threads; all counts come from a script. Every quote was matched word for word against the saved page, and every number in the write-up was recounted — those checks caught 9 bad quotes and 3 wrong numbers in earlier drafts.